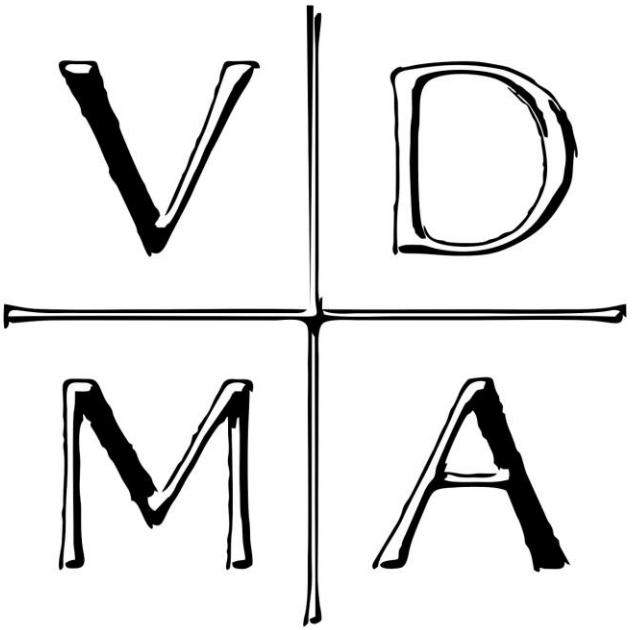
Ascension of Christ Lutheran Church

16935 W. 14 Mile Road, Beverly Hills, Michigan 48025
Phone: 248.644.8890 **Web:** www.ascensionofchrist.org

The Reverend Larry K. Loree, Jr., Pastor

A member congregation of The English District of
The Lutheran Church-Missouri Synod



Verbum Domini Manet in Aeternum
The Word of the Lord Endures Forever

Festival of the Reformation (observed)

October 25, 2026

+IN THE NAME OF JESUS+

WELCOME to the Divine Service at Ascension of Christ! We pray that you will be richly blessed by God as you hear His Word, receive His gifts and worship Him with your prayer and praise!

TO OUR GUESTS Welcome, we are glad that you have chosen to worship with us this morning. Please don't hesitate to ask an usher or a greeter if you have any questions. Be sure to introduce yourself to our Pastor. We invite you to consider Ascension of Christ if you are looking for a church home. We gather every Sunday morning for Adult Bible Study at 9:00 a.m., the Divine Service at 10:15 a.m., and Fellowship Hour and Sunday School following the Divine Service.

CHILDREN AT ASCENSION At Ascension, we want you to feel at home. First, please relax and enjoy your time here. Jesus knows that children tend to wiggle and squawk a bit, so please don't feel embarrassed by it. Your children are welcome here! To make it easier on your family, please dare to sit closer to the front where your children can easily see what's going on, note the colors, watch the pastors, wonder about those heads on the lectern, and embrace the action at the altar. What Jesus does here is for them, too! As we go through the Divine Service, encourage them to join in on their parts: *Amen! Lord have mercy. And with your spirit. I believe! Our Father!* And please be sure to sing and pray your parts too! Children learn by following your lead. There are some busy bags in the back of the church for you and if you must take your children out of the church, please hurry back!

THE LORD'S SUPPER IS JOYFULLY RECEIVED HERE TODAY At the altar, our Lord Jesus Christ delivers His true body and blood into our mouths. His gift of body and blood given in, with, and under the bread and wine, bestows tremendous benefits. His body and blood forgives our sins, strengthens our faith, binds us to the Lord, and unites us with each other. In this is life and salvation. **All members of The Lutheran Church-Missouri Synod have publicly confessed this sacred gift and its blessings and so are encouraged to commune.** When you have examined yourself according to Christ's bidding (1 Corinthians 11:28), come to His Supper rejoicing, just as Jesus asks, knowing that our Lord meets you at His altar with joy. **If you are a guest** and would like to learn more about the practice of the Lord's Supper at Ascension of Christ, or if you are uncertain about whether you should receive the Lord's Supper, **please speak with Pastor Loree before communing for the first time.**

REFORMATION DAY (observed) ***The Son of God Has Set Us Free from Sin and Death by His Grace***

"Wisdom is justified by her deeds" (Matt. 11:19), and the true Wisdom of God, Christ Jesus the incarnate Son, justifies us by His deeds. He prepares His way by the preaching of repentance, but He has suffered the violence of the Law and voluntarily handed Himself over to violent men, that we might eat and drink with Him in His Kingdom and "remain in the house forever" (John 8:35). For He is "a friend of tax collectors and sinners" (Matt. 11:19), and He has rescued us by His grace from the slavery of sin and death. By the proclamation of His eternal Gospel "to those who dwell on earth, to every nation and tribe and language and people" (Rev. 14:6), "the righteousness of God has been manifested apart from the law" (Rom. 3:21), "that He might be just and the justifier of the one who has faith in Jesus" (Rom. 3:26). And by hearing the Gospel of Christ Jesus, "whom God put forward as a propitiation by His blood, to be received by faith" (Rom. 3:25), "you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free" (John 8:31–32).

+GOD GATHERS US BEFORE HIS HOLY PRESENCE+

Please note the ♪ symbol is used to indicate a sung response.

PRELUDE *Please stand at the sound of the chimes*

HYMN ***A MIGHTY FORTRESS IS OUR GOD*** **LSB 656**

The congregation can either sit or turn and face the font during the rite of Baptism (LSB 268).

THE HOLY BAPTISM OF NOAH ROBERT FRANCO

P Dearly beloved, Christ our Lord says in the last chapter of Matthew, "All authority in heaven and on earth has been given to Me. Therefore go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit." In the last chapter of Mark our Lord promises, "Whoever believes and is baptized will be saved." And the apostle Peter has written, "Baptism now saves you."

The Word of God also teaches that we are all conceived and born sinful and are under the power of the devil until Christ claims us as His own.

Therefore, depart, you unclean spirit, and make room for the Holy Spirit in the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit.

The pastor makes the sign of the holy cross upon the forehead and heart of the candidate while saying:

P Receive the sign of the holy cross both upon your ✠ forehead and upon your ✠ heart to mark you as one redeemed by Christ the crucified.

P Almighty and eternal God, according to Your strict judgment You condemned the unbelieving world through the flood, yet according to Your great mercy You preserved believing Noah and his family, eight souls in all. You drowned hard-hearted Pharaoh and all his host in the Red Sea, yet led Your people Israel through the water on dry ground, foreshadowing this washing of Your Holy Baptism. Through the Baptism in the Jordan of Your beloved Son, our Lord Jesus Christ, You sanctified and instituted all waters to be a blessed flood and a lavish washing away of sin.

We pray that You would behold *Noah Robert* according to Your boundless mercy and bless him with true faith by the Holy Spirit, that through this saving flood all sin in him which has been inherited from Adam and which he himself has committed since, would be drowned and die. Grant that he be kept safe and secure in the holy ark of the Christian Church, being separated from the multitude of unbelievers and serving Your name at all times with a fervent spirit and a joyful hope, so that, with all believers in Your promise, he would be declared worthy of eternal life; through Jesus Christ, our Lord.

C **Amen.**

℗ Hear the Holy Gospel according to St. Mark.

They brought young children to [Jesus] that He might touch them; but the disciples rebuked those who brought them. But when Jesus saw it, He was greatly displeased and said to them, "Let the little children come to Me, and do not forbid them; for of such is the kingdom of God. Assuredly, I say to you, whoever does not receive the kingdom of God as a little child will by no means enter it." And He took them up in His arms, put His hands on them, and blessed them.

The pastor places his hands on the head of the candidate, and the congregation joins in praying:

THE LORD'S PRAYER

℗ The Lord preserve your coming in and your going out from this time forth and even ✣ forevermore.

℃ **Amen.**

The pastor addresses the candidate(s) and asks the following questions:

℗ *Noah Robert,* do you renounce the devil?
℟ *Yes, I renounce him.*
℗ Do you renounce all his works?
℟ *Yes, I renounce them.*
℗ Do you renounce all his ways?
℟ *Yes, I renounce them.*

℗ Do you believe in God, the Father Almighty, maker of heaven and earth?
℟ *Yes, I believe.*

℗ Do you believe in Jesus Christ, His only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, died and was buried; He descended into hell; the third day He rose again from the dead; He ascended into heaven and sits at the right hand of God the Father Almighty; from thence He will come to judge the living and the dead?
℟ *Yes, I believe.*

℗ Do you believe in the Holy Spirit, the holy Christian Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting?
℟ *Yes, I believe.*

℗ *Noah Robert,* do you desire to be baptized?
℟ *Yes, I do.*

The pastor pours water three times on the head of each candidate while saying:

℗ *Noah Robert,* I baptize you in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit.

Ⓒ Amen.

The newly baptized is sealed with sacred chrism, symbolizing the sealing of the Spirit's gifts of grace and saving faith.

℗ The almighty God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who has given you the new birth of water and of the Spirit and has forgiven you all your sins, strengthen you with His grace to life ✢ everlasting.

Ⓒ Amen.

℗ Peace ✢ be with you.

Ⓒ Amen.

The choir sings the Introit as the newly baptized and those gathered around the font return to their places.

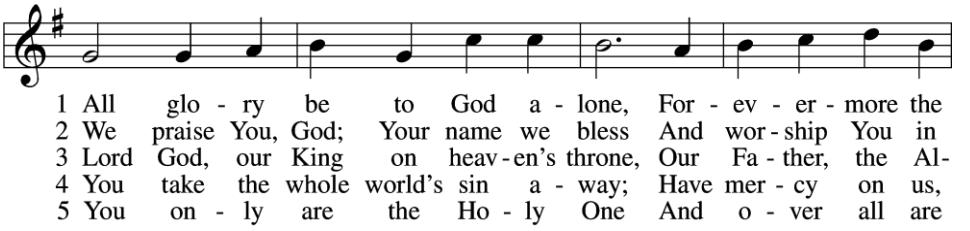
INTROIT *Psalm 46:7, 2, 1*

The Lord of hosts is with us:
the God of Jacob is our Refuge.
Therefore will not we fear, though the earth be removed:
and though the mountains be carried into the midst of the sea.
God is our Refuge and Strength:
a very present Help in trouble.
Glory be to the Father, and to the Son,
and to the Holy Spirit.
As it was in the beginning,
is now and will be forever. Amen.
The Lord of hosts is with us:
the God of Jacob is our Refuge.
Therefore will not we fear, though the earth be removed:
and though the mountains be carried into the midst of the sea.

KYRIE! GOD, FATHER



GLORIA IN EXCELSIS *ALL GLORY BE TO GOD ALONE*





SALUTATION AND COLLECT OF THE DAY

P The Lord be with you.

C **And with thy spirit.**

Let us pray. Almighty and gracious Lord, pour out Your Holy Spirit on Your faithful people. Keep us steadfast in Your grace and truth, protect and deliver us in times of temptation, defend us against all enemies, and grant to Your Church Your saving peace; through Jesus Christ, Your Son, our Lord, who lives and reigns with You and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever.

C **Amen.**

+GOD SPEAKS TO US IN HIS WORD+

Sit

FIRST READING *Revelation 14:6–7*

6 Then I saw another angel flying in the midst of heaven, having the everlasting gospel to preach to those who dwell on the earth—to every nation, tribe, tongue, and people—7 saying with a loud voice, "Fear God and give glory to Him, for the hour of His judgment has come; and worship Him who made heaven and earth, the sea and springs of water."

P This is the Word of the Lord.

C **Thanks be to God.**

CHORAL ANTHEM "Lord, Help Us Ever to Retain" Ludwig Hembold

SECOND READING *Romans 3:19-28*

Brethren: 19 Now we know that whatever the law says, it says to those who are under the law, that every mouth may be stopped, and all the world may become guilty before God. 20 Therefore by the deeds of the law no flesh will be justified in His sight, for by the law *is* the knowledge of sin.

21 But now the righteousness of God apart from the law is revealed, being witnessed by the Law and the Prophets, 22 even the righteousness of God, through faith in Jesus Christ, to all and on all who believe. For there is no difference; 23 for all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God, 24 being justified freely by His grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus, 25 whom God set forth *as* a propitiation by His blood, through faith, to demonstrate His righteousness, because in His forbearance God had passed over the sins that were previously committed, 26 to demonstrate at the present time His righteousness, that He might be just and the justifier of the one who has faith in Jesus.

27 Where *is* boasting then? It is excluded. By what law? Of works? No, but by the law of faith. 28 Therefore we conclude that a man is justified by faith apart from the deeds of the law.

℗ This is the Word of the Lord.
℃ **Thanks be to God.**

Stand

ALLELUIA



HOLY GOSPEL *St. John 8:31-36*

℗ The Holy Gospel according to St. John, the eighth chapter.
℃ ♪**Glory be to Thee, O Lord.**

31 Then Jesus said to those Jews who believed Him, "If you abide in My word, you are My disciples indeed. 32 And you shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free."

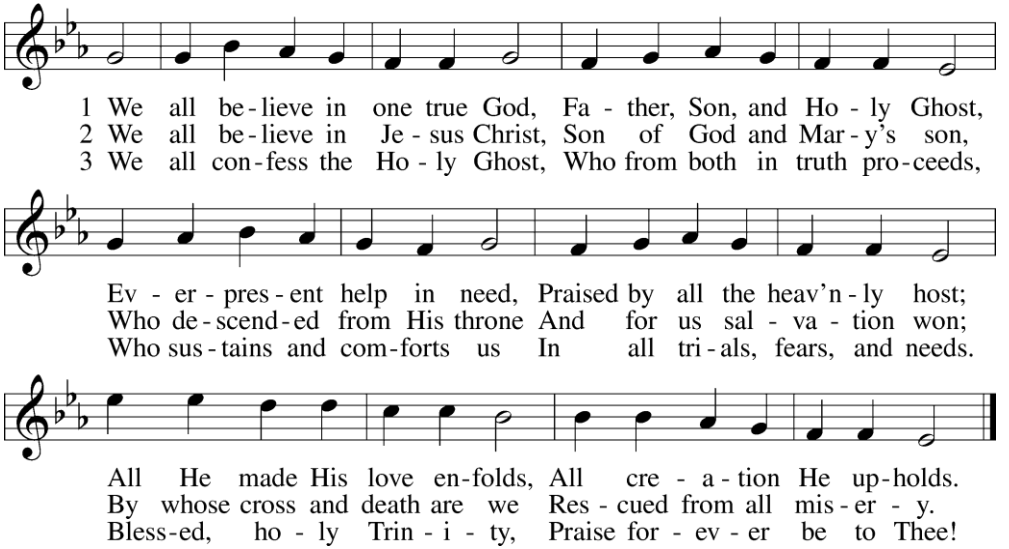
33 They answered Him, "We are Abraham's descendants, and have never been in bondage to anyone. How *can* You say, 'You will be made free'?"

[34] Jesus answered them, "Most assuredly, I say to you, whoever commits sin is a slave of sin. [35] And a slave does not abide in the house forever, *but* a son abides forever. [36] Therefore if the Son makes you free, you shall be free indeed.

P This is the Gospel of the Lord.

C **Praise be to Thee, O Christ.**

CREED ***WE ALL BELIEVE IN ONE TRUE GOD***



Sit

HYMN OF THE DAY ***SALVATION UNTO US HAS COME* (*stanzas 1-5*)** **LSB 555**

SERMON

CONFIRMATION OF NEW MEMBERS & RECEPTION OF NEW MEMBER

+GOD RECEIVES OUR PRAYERS & OFFERINGS+

Kneel/Stand

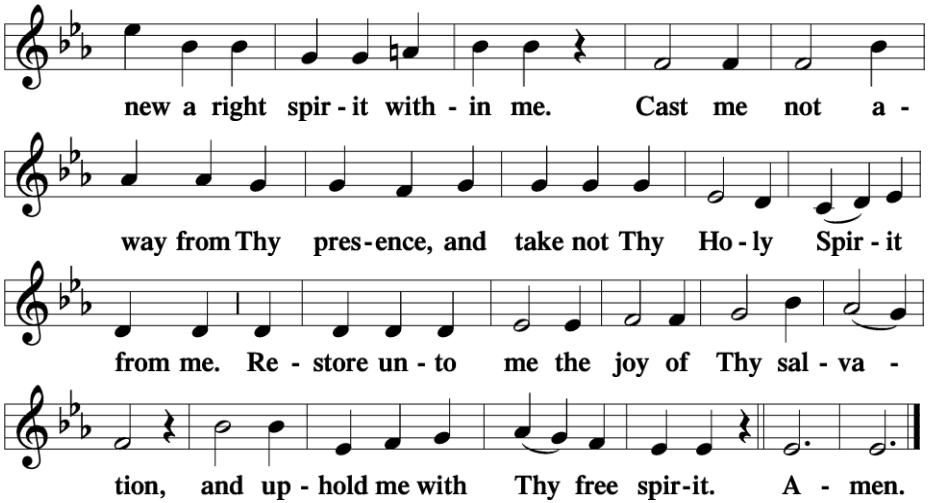
PRAYER OF THE CHURCH

Sit

OFFERING "Rejoice, The Lord Is King" arr. Bill Ingram

OFFERTORY





+GOD GIVES A FORETASTE OF THE FEAST TO COME+

PREFACE & PROPER PREFACE

P The Lord be with you.

C **And with thy spirit.**

P Lift up your hearts.

C **We lift them up unto the Lord.**

P Let us give thanks to the Lord our God.

C **It is meet and right so to do.**

P It is truly meet, right, and salutary that we should at all times and in all places give thanks to You, O Lord our God, king of all creation, for You have had mercy on us and given Your only-begotten Son that whoever believes in Him should not perish but have eternal life. Grant us Your Spirit, gracious Father, that we may give heed to the testament of Your Son in true faith and, above all, firmly take to heart the words with which Christ gives to us His body and blood for our forgiveness. By Your grace, lead us to remember and give thanks for the boundless love which He manifested to us when, by pouring out His precious blood, He saved us from Your righteous wrath and from sin, death, and hell. Grant that we may receive the bread and wine, that is, His body and blood, as a gift, guarantee, and pledge of His salvation. Graciously receive our prayers; deliver and preserve us. To You alone, O Father, be all glory, honor, and worship, with the Son and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever.

C **Amen.**

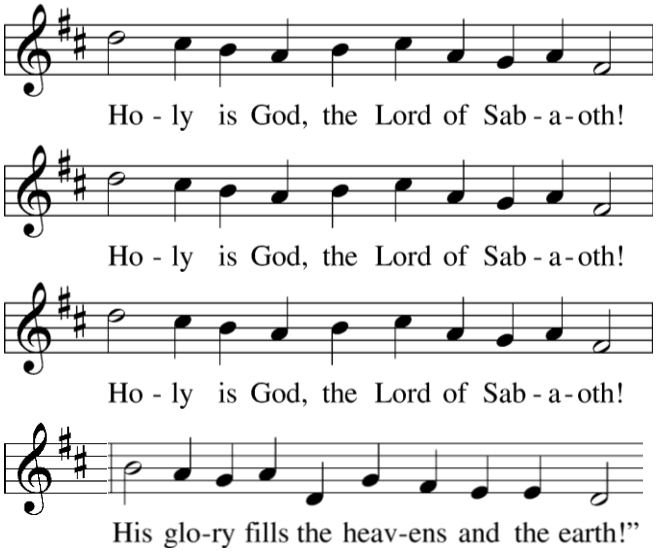
THE WORDS OF OUR LORD

SANCTUS ***ISAIAH, MIGHTY SEER IN DAYS OF OLD*** *Choir & Congregation*

Choir

Isaiah, mighty seer in days of old,
The Lord of all in spirit did behold
High on a lofty throne, in splendor bright,
With robes that filled the temple courts with light.
Above the throne were flaming seraphim;
Six wings had they, these messengers of Him.
With two they veiled their faces as was right,
With two they humbly hid their feet from sight,
And with the other two aloft they soared;
One to the other called and praised the Lord:

Congregation



Choir

The beams and lintels trembled at the cry,
And clouds of smoke enwrapped the throne on high.

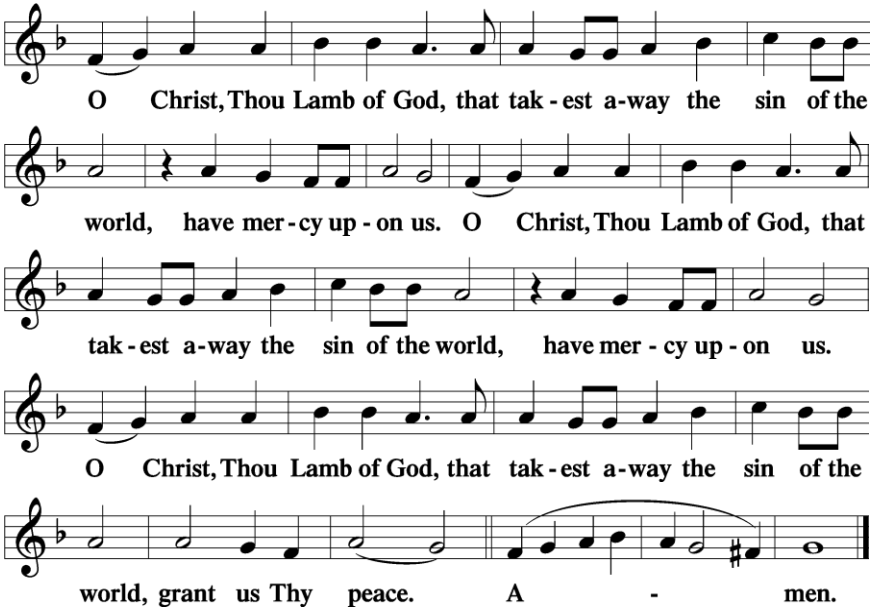
LORD'S PRAYER

PAX DOMINI

P The peace ✢ of the Lord be with you always.

C ♪**Amen.**

AGNUS DEI



Sit

DISTRIBUTION OF HOLY COMMUNION

SALVATION UNTO HAS COME (stanzas 6-10)	**LSB 555**
DEAR CHRISTIANS , ONE AND ALL, REJOICE	**LSB 556**
O LORD, WE PRAISE THEE	**LSB 617**

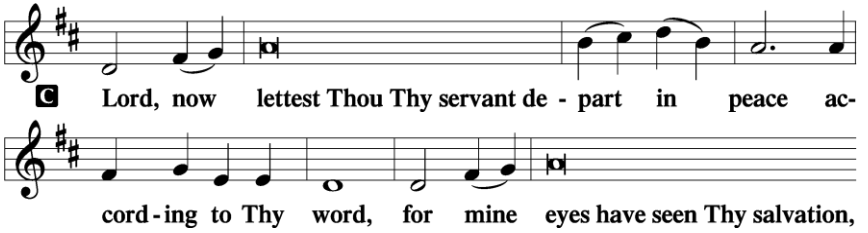
Stand

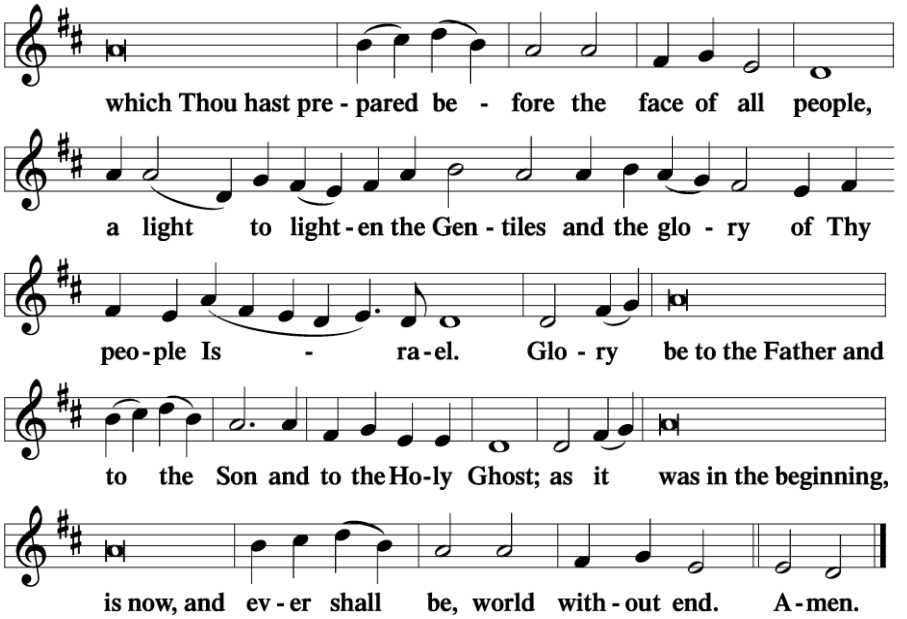
DISMISSAL

℗ The true body and precious blood of your Lord and Savior Jesus Christ strengthen you in body and soul to life everlasting. Depart ☩ in peace.

℃ **Amen.**

NUNC DIMITTIS





THANKSGIVING

P O give thanks unto the Lord, for He is good,

C **and His mercy endureth forever.**

POST-COMMUNION PRAYER

P Let us pray. We give thanks to You, almighty God, that You have refreshed us through this salutary gift, and we implore You that of Your mercy You would strengthen us through the same in faith toward You and in fervent love toward one another; through Jesus Christ, Your Son, our Lord, who lives and reigns with You and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever.

C **Amen.**

SALUTATION AND BENEDICAMUS

P The Lord be with you.

C **And with thy spirit.**

P Bless we the Lord.

C **Thanks be to God.**

BENEDICTION

℗ The Lord bless you and keep you. The Lord make His face to shine upon you and be gracious to you. The Lord lift up His countenance upon you and ✢ give you peace.

© ♪**Amen, Amen, Amen**

HYMN TO DEPART *LORD, KEEP US STEADFAST IN YOUR WORD* **LSB 655**

POSTLUDE

+TO GOD ALONE BE GLORY+

Weekly Announcements (Oct. 25 – Oct. 31)

Ascension of Christ is a community of believers in Jesus centered on the proclamation of Christ crucified where the Baptized are encouraged to grow in faith and to serve all people with love.

Sunday, October 25
9:00 a.m. – Bible Study on Matthew's Gospel
10:15 a.m. – Divine Service
11:30 a.m. – Fellowship
11:30 a.m. – Sunday school & Confirmation

Tuesday, October 27
6:00p.m. – Human Care Team Meeting

Wednesday, October 28
7:00 p.m. – Evening Prayer *(with study)*

Thursday, October 29
6:30 p.m. – Trunk or Treat

RECEPTION OF NEW MEMBERS INTO THE ASCENSION OF CHRIST FAMILY
With great joy, we receive the following new members into the Body of Christ in this place: Brian Dumont, Noah Franco, and Dale Wollicki. Please stop by Fellowship Hour after today's service and welcome them into our congregational family.

TRUNK OR TREAT
On Thursday, October 29th, from 6-7:30 p.m. we will have our annual Trunk or Treat event in the 14 Mile Rd. parking lot. To make this year's event successful, please consider signing up to decorate your vehicle and distribute treats to the children and families of our AoC community.

PEACE PANTRY THANKSGIVING TURKEY DINNER DRIVE
Sunday October 18th—November 8, 2026

- **Boxed potatoes**
- **Stuffing Mix**
- **Cranberry sauce**
- **Gravy packets**
- **Mac and cheese**
- **Jiffy Corn muffin mix**
- **Dinner Napkins**

WEEKLY EVENING PRAYER *(Oct. through May)*
Evening Prayer is prayed at 7 p.m. each Wednesday. On the second and fourth Wednesdays, a 30-minute discussion of a selected book on spirituality or liturgy follows Evening Prayer for those who wish to participate. Our goal is to begin at 7 p.m. and conclude promptly at 8 p.m. The current book is Heaven on Earth: The Gifts of the Divine Service by Arthur A. Just Jr.

SUNDAY MORNING BIBLE CLASS
We are currently studying the Gospel of Matthew using the new Concordia Commentary Bible Study series as our discussion guide. Study sheets are available on the table at the back of the church (nave).

THURSDAY BIBLE CLASS
Come join Pastor Berg at the next Thursday morning Bible class. Topics: The Book of Ruth. This class meets the 1st and3rd Thursdays of the month at 10 a.m. in the Fellowship Hall. Next class will meet on 11/05.

MEN'S LUTHERAN CONFESSIONS STUDY
Grow in faith. Learn together. Join the conversation. Men are invited to join Timothy Stegall for a study of the Lutheran Confessions at Ascension of Christ. **Next meeting: Saturday, October 24, at 9 a.m. Location: Ascension of Christ Lutheran Church.** Come deepen your understanding of our Lutheran faith and enjoy fellowship with other men. For more information, contact **Timothy Stegall at 248-804-6592** or timothy@timothystegall.com.

PRAYER PARTNERS
We are in need of additional volunteers for our Prayer Partners program this year. Upon signing up, you will be assigned 1-2 children from our Child Care or Preschool to pray for throughout the year.

This is a simple way to connect with our child care and support our ministry to the children and their families. Please consider joining us! A sign-up sheet has been posted to the bulletin board near the fellowship hall, or contact Chelsea Cook, cookc@ascensionofchrist.org.

PRAYER SUBMISSIONS
Prayer requests submitted before NOON on Thursdays will be included in the following Sunday's prayers. You can submit prayer requests at: https://tinyurl.com/AOCPrayers

Ascension at Prayer

For healing, recovery, special needs
Members: Ralph Cook, Allen Kerkes, Mary Ellyn Lambert, Karen Rousseaux, Joan Berndt, Kurt Birnbaum, Lily Burchart, Jeanne Cressman**,** Elsie Elsholz, Renee Hecker, Joyce Maria Iott, Chuck Jackson, Georgie Jackson, Edith Marinko, Pat Nieman, Sue Boyle

Friends, Family and Former Members: David Cressman (Jean Cressman's son), Ellen Tate (Pr. Loree's godmother), Jordan Marshall (childcare student), Michael Grennan (Nancy Slater's nephew), Jane and Dr. Robert Schwyn (Joan Berndt's cousins), George Nischik (Marissa Cooper's father), Alice Kokoszyna (Joan Berndt's sister), Mark Coffman, Earleen Katz, Tami McGillan, Anthony Martinez, (Friends of Erika Broderdorf), David Cressman (Jeanne Cressman's son), Pete Jackson (Chuck and Georgie Jackson's son), Joan Pulliam (Debbie Nathan's aunt), Beverly Lee (Sarah Burchart's grandmother), Betty Broderdorf (Ken Broderdorf's mother) Kenny Boyle (Susan Boyle son).

For those who mourn
The Francisco family upon the death of Joe's mother, Rita Kingsbury

For those who are pregnant
Julia Culbert, Sarah Ford, Stephanie Mabry

For our catechumens
Kaiden Blanski, Joseph Carmona, Kellis Cook, Melia Fellman, and Allie Francisco

For our childcare families & staff
Cowing, Daniels, Eaton, and Egan families // Chelsea, Sharon, Vivian, Monice and Kyah

For our congregation/district/synod church leaders
Pastor Loree (Teresa); Emma Stegall (Timothy); Rev. Timothy Holzerland (Circuit Visitor), the congregations of the Detroit North Circuit, and Rev. Solomon Spangler (Circuit Visitor), the congregations of the Detroit South Circuit;
Rev. Dr. Matthew Harrison (LCMS President), Rev. Jeffrey Miskus (English District Bishop/President)

For those persecuted on account of Christ *(These are places in the world where it is most difficult to follow Jesus)* Christians living in Afghanistan, India, and Syria, where the humanitarian situation for Christians in these regions is particularly dire at the present time, marked by violence and massacre, displacement, and international concern over government inaction and, in some cases, complicity.

For missionaries/partner churches
Rev. Dr. Timothy Beckendorf (Lisa, Aaron, and Andrew) and his work with Lutheran Bible Translators in Botswana;
Rev. Ted Krey (Rebecca, Esther, Matthias, Natalia, Evangeline, and Azariah) and his work as regional director for the Latin America and the Caribbean region of the LCMS; Confessional Lutheran Church in Switzerland (CLCS); South East of Lake Victoria Diocese (SELVD-ELCT)

For those serving in the Armed Forces
Mitchell Grams, USAF; Andrew Seaver, USAF; Patrick Richert, USMC (nephew of Anna Richert); Adam Card, USAF, (brother-in-law of Mary Blohm)

For those rejoicing
Birthdays: Elsie Elsholz (10/02), Marissa Ketelhut (10/02), Mitchell Grams (10/04), Vincent Fiore (10/05), Stephanie Mabry (10/06), Chelsea Cook (10/07), Leonardo Fiore (10/08), Darla Steeh (10/08), Jeffrey Franz (10/11), Peter Paselk (10/12), Kurt Birnbaum (10/17), Bob Marinko (10/17), Erika Broderdorf (10/18), Nick Burcart (10/21), Hal Franz (10/21), Caleb Iott (10/28), Renee Hecker (10/29).

Anniversaries: Chuck & Georgia Jackson (10/02), Mike & Sharon Florio (10/16), Don & Jan Studt (10/25)

To submit prayer requests visit: https://tinyurl.com/AOCPrayers